

Whitney Kotlewski, PhD

VP of Product | Product Strategy | Portfolio Leadership | AI, Data & Spatial Platforms

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SUMMARY

Product executive with 17 years inventing and scaling B2B platforms across AI, data, spatial analytics, 3D and digital twins, and mission-critical operations, including 5 years in senior leadership (Director/Sr. Director/VP). VP of Product at Slingshot Aerospace reporting to the CTO; leads vision, strategy, and multi-product roadmaps; builds AI-powered planning systems; and scales organizations that deliver impact.

EXPERIENCE

Slingshot Aerospace, El Segundo, CA

Apr 2024 – Present

VP of Product (2025–Present) / Sr. Director of Product (2024–2025) / Head of Product Design & Research (2024)

- Report to the CTO; scaled the product organization from 3 to 19 across product management, strategy and design, research, customer experience, and space data (US/UK).
- Own SOIA vision and roadmaps; launched Slingshot Portal (2026), an AI-native platform for Sense, Fuse, Decide, and Act across space domain awareness, fusion, analytics, and mission decision support.
- Growth window: about \$124M capital raised and \$96M+ in U.S. Space Force awards, including a \$27M AI training contract and company-record \$69.2M MENTAT SBIR Phase III.
- Built an AI product-strategy knowledge base from about 250 research documents into scored opportunities (about \$345M) and regenerable roadmaps; established Nebula and Rocket Fuel design systems for Portal go-to-market.

Matterport, Sunnyvale, CA

Apr 2021 – Oct 2023

Director, Product Design (Platform & Services)

- Joined through a roughly \$2.9B public listing; led post-IPO product design across eight experiences as revenue grew from about \$111M to \$158M and subscribers from about 503K to 938K.
- Scaled design from 1 to 8 and co-led org growth from 6 to 20; evolved design systems, accessibility, and research; integrated AI/ML into 3D digital-twin experiences.

Esri, Redlands, CA

Oct 2014 – Apr 2021

Head of UX Innovation (2019–2021) / Co-Founder / Director, Black Girls MAPP (2019–2021) / Design Lead & Sr. UX Architect (2014–2019)

- Led product and UX innovation in a GIS platform business growing from about \$1.1B to \$1.3B+ revenue across mobile navigation, Insights analytics, Site Scan, and desktop 2D/3D mapping.
- Founded Black Girls MAPP: a 150+ person initiative delivering 24 maps, 24 layers, 59 apps, and 10 civic products; 2021 AAG Diversity & Inclusion Award.

Also: Executive Design Advisor, Sonara (2022–2023), about 80x subscription growth; Adjunct Professor, CGU Design for Good Incubator (2024–Present); CX Lead, Pacific Life (2014); UX Lead / Instructor, IUPUI (2010–2013).

EDUCATION

PhD, Information Systems & Technology, Claremont Graduate University, 2017–2024 (AI / data visualization dissertation; patent pending).

MS, Informatics, IUPUI. **MS, Human-Computer Interaction** and **BA**, Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Product Vision and strategy, roadmap prioritization, OKRs, discovery through delivery, go-to-market, org scaling

Innovation AI knowledge-base operations, opportunity sizing, Nebula and Rocket Fuel, zero-to-one platforms

Domain AI/ML, data visualization, spatial/GIS, 3D digital twin, B2B software, mission intelligence

Recognition AAG Diversity & Inclusion Award (2021); GIS for Science Technology Showcase, Vol. 3, Esri Press (2023); PhD dissertation (ProQuest, 2024); patent pending